

Deep Dive: Guardrails For Burnout

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Okay, we've touched on things you need to keep in mind in order to be "in it for the long haul." Now let's take a closer look at burnout.

When it comes to being in it for the long haul, first, begin with the end in mind. What do YOU need to "go the distance?"

Stop and think about that for a second. Is it a certain salary level? Maybe it's earning enough to afford childcare, or a job that offers remote options for work-life balance? I

s it a position located within a certain area of your home, or are you willing to move? How much are you willing to commute? What about retirement options, like a 401K plan?

Start by making a list of where you want to be in 10 years. What does that job look like?

You may want to split things into two categories, what the "dream version" of that job looks like and what are non-negotiables for you to be working in 10 years.

The dream version can include things like a certain title, or the goal of having a certain position in a certain industry. The non-negotiable side may include things like a minimum salary or how much travel the job involves.

There are things we do when we're starting off in our careers that we won't do when we're older. In your 20s you may not have kids, so working unconventional hours or traveling on a moment's notice doesn't matter. You may not be married or have a house so you might be willing to move for that big opportunity.

Things usually change the further we get into our career. You learn what's important to you, and what you will and don't compromise on. Even if a spouse or kids aren't a consideration, you usually have other obligations or interests that influence your deal-breakers in the workplace.

Maybe you're an adrenaline junkie who thrives in an unexpected, fast-paced environment and you know you like the element of excitement in your career. Maybe you're the opposite – you prefer professional but predictable, with a steady course.

When you *know* where you're going – the end result – and you know your boundaries, navigating your career options as they present themselves becomes a little clearer.

This is important, because to avoid burnout you need to know where your boundaries are and how to safeguard them when you find yourself getting pushed close to the line.